

Absolutely — **praise** is a useful secondary polysemy/family target because your passage uses it here:

> “I have heard colleagues, neighbours, and even people online **praising** it...”

Here **praise** means **to express strong approval or admiration for the bakery**. The word is not extremely polysemous, but it has several important grammatical and register uses, plus a strong noun/verb contrast.

Word family: **praise / praised / praising / praiseworthy**

Base word: praise

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞)

Related adjective: praiseworthy

Meaning in your passage: **praise = express approval or admiration — 稱讚；讚揚；讚賞**

Your sentence:

> “I have heard colleagues, neighbours, and even people online **praising** it...”

Here **praising** means:

> **speaking positively about the bakery because they think it is very good.**

繁體中文：

因為覺得某人 / 某事物很好，而公開或明確地表達欣賞、肯定或讚許

Natural translation:

> “I have heard ... people online praising it.”

「我聽過同事、鄰居，甚至網民都在**稱讚 / 讚賞**這間店。」

So here:

> **praise = 對 Golden Crust 表達正面評價和欣賞**

1. **praise = say that someone/something is good — 稱讚；讚揚**

The core verb meaning.

Practice 1 — Original

> “People online were **praising** the bakery.”

「網民都在**稱讚**這間麵包店。」

Practice 2

> “Customers praised the quality of the bread.”

「顧客**讚揚**麵包的品質。」

Practice 3

> “The manager praised the staff for their hard work.”

「經理因員工努力工作而**表揚**他們。」

praise = 明確表達對某人 / 某事的高度肯定、欣賞或認可

2. **praise someone for + noun/-ing** — 因.....而稱讚某人

A very important grammar pattern.

Practice 4

> “The owner praised the staff **for their excellent service**.”

「店主因員工提供出色服務而**稱讚**他們。」

Practice 5

> “She was praised **for handling the complaint calmly**.”

「她因冷靜處理投訴而受到**表揚**。」

praise someone for X = 因某項行為、品質或成就而稱讚某人

3. **praise something as + noun/adjective** — 稱讚某物是.....；譽為.....

A common formal pattern.

Practice 6

> “Critics praised the bakery **as one of the best in the area**.”

「評論者**盛讚**這間麵包店是區內最好的一間。」

Practice 7

> “The design was praised as simple and effective.”

「這個設計被**讚揚為**簡潔而有效。」

praise X as Y = 公開肯定某人 / 某物具有某種優點、地位或特色

4. **praise** = noun, approval/admiration — 讚美；讚揚；稱讚

The main noun use.

Practice 8

> “The bakery received a lot of **praise**.”

「這間麵包店獲得很多**讚賞**。」

Practice 9

> “Her work deserves praise.”

「她的工作值得**讚揚**。」

praise — noun = 對某人 / 某事表達的正面評價、欣賞或肯定

Usually uncountable.

5. **receive/win/earn praise** = 獲得讚賞 / 贏得讚譽

A very common noun collocation.

Practice 10

> “The new product **won praise** from customers.”

「新產品**贏得顧客讚賞**。」

Practice 11

> “The staff earned praise for their professionalism.”

「員工因專業表現而**獲得讚譽**。」

earn/win/receive praise = 因表現良好而得到他人的正面評價

6. **high praise = 高度讚賞；高度評價**

Practice 12

> “The bakery received **high praise** from local customers.”

「這間麵包店獲得本地顧客的**高度讚賞**。」

Practice 13

> “That is high praise coming from such a strict critic.”

「由這麼嚴格的評論者說出來，這算是**很高的評價**。」

high praise = 非常強烈的正面評價

7. **praise = worship/glorify in a religious context — 頌讚；讚美**

A distinct religious/register use.

Practice 14

> “They gathered to **praise** God.”

「他們聚集一起**讚美上帝**。」

Practice 15

> “The song praises God’s mercy.”

「這首歌**頌讚**上帝的慈悲。」

****praise — religious = 以崇敬、感恩或敬拜的方式讚美神****

This is more than ordinary complimenting.

8. ****praise = noun in religious worship — 頌讚；讚美****

Practice 16

> “The congregation sang songs of ****praise****.”

「會眾唱起****頌讚****詩歌。」

Practice 17

> “They offered praise and thanks.”

「他們獻上****讚美與感謝****。」

****praise — religious noun = 對神表達敬拜、崇敬和感謝****

9. ****praiseworthy = deserving praise — 值得讚揚的；可嘉的****

A useful related adjective.

Practice 18

> “Their commitment to quality is ****praiseworthy****.”

「他們對品質的堅持****值得讚揚****。」

Practice 19

> “Her honesty was ****praiseworthy****.”

「她的誠實態度****可嘉****。」

****praiseworthy = 因表現、品格或行為良好而值得受到稱讚的****

Register:

* formal

Important distinction: **praise vs compliment**

praise

broader and often stronger:

= praise someone's work, achievement, behaviour, quality.

compliment

often a polite positive remark, especially about appearance or a specific personal quality.

> "The manager praised her work."

> = 經理稱讚她的工作。

> "He complimented her on her dress."

> = 他稱讚她的衣著。

So **praise** often feels more evaluative/substantial.

Important distinction: **praise vs admire**

admire

= feel respect or appreciation internally.

praise

= express that approval outwardly.

> "I admire her work."

> = 我欣賞她的工作。

> "I praised her work."

> = 我開口稱讚她的工作。

Very important distinction.

Important distinction: **praise vs appreciate**

appreciate

= recognize value / feel grateful.

praise

= explicitly speak positively about.

> appreciate good service

> = 欣賞 / 感激良好服務

> praise good service

> = 公開稱讚良好服務

Important distinction: **praise vs recommend**

praise

= say something is good.

recommend

= advise someone to choose/use it.

> “She praised the bakery.”

> = 她稱讚這間麵包店。

> “She recommended the bakery.”

> = 她推薦這間麵包店。

Someone can praise something without directly recommending it.

Important distinction: **praise vs review**

review

= evaluate, often including positives and negatives.

praise

= specifically positive evaluation.

> positive review

> may contain praise

but:

> review ≠ praise

Important distinction: ****praise vs flatter****

****praise****

= genuine or apparently genuine approval.

****flatter****

= praise someone excessively or strategically, often to please/manipulate them.

> praise a worker

> = 真誠表揚

> flatter the boss

> = 奉承老闆

Very useful semantic contrast.

Important distinction: ****praise vs applaud****

****applaud****

literally:

= clap hands

figuratively:

= strongly approve.

****praise****

= express approval in words.

> “Critics praised the decision.”

> = 評論者稱讚這個決定。

> “Many people applauded the decision.”

> = 很多人對這個決定表示支持 / 讚許。

Important distinction: ****praise vs credit****

****praise****

= say someone did well.

****credit someone with something****

= recognize that they deserve responsibility for a good result.

> praise the chef

> = 稱讚廚師

> credit the chef with improving the menu

> = 認為餐單改善是廚師的功勞

Important distinction: ****praise — verb vs noun****

Verb:

> “Customers ****praised**** the bakery.”

= 顧客稱讚這間麵包店。

Noun:

> “The bakery received ****praise****.”

= 麵包店獲得讚賞。

Same core concept, different grammar.

Important distinction: ****praise is usually uncountable****

Normally:

> much praise

> high praise

> receive praise

Not usually:

> ❌ many praises

However, **praises** exists in religious/literary contexts:

> “sing his praises”

So for ordinary evaluative use, treat **praise** as uncountable.

Important expression: **sing someone's praises = 極力稱讚某人**

A useful idiom.

Practice 20

> “Her customers are always **singing her praises**.”

「她的顧客總是**對她讚不絕口**。」

Practice 21

> “His colleagues sang his praises after the event.”

「活動結束後，他的同事都**大力稱讚他**。」

sing someone's praises = 非常熱情地、不斷地稱讚某人

Not literal singing in most contexts.

Important expression: **damn with faint praise = 明褒暗貶**

A more advanced idiom.

Practice 22

> “Calling the food ‘quite acceptable’ sounded like **damning it with faint praise**.”

「把食物說成『還算可以』，聽起來簡直是**明褒暗貶**。」

Practice 23

> “The review damned the film with faint praise.”

「那篇評論用看似稱讚的方式，實際上**貶低了這部電影**。」

damn with faint praise = 用很勉強、很弱的稱讚，反而暗示對方其實不怎麼好

Register:

* advanced

* idiomatic

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory includes:

* **praise — verb** = 稱讚 / 讚揚 / 讚賞

* **praise someone for X** = 因.....而稱讚某人

* **praise X as Y** = 稱讚 / 譽為.....

* **praise — noun** = 讚美 / 讚揚 / 讚賞

* **receive/win/earn praise** = 獲得讚譽

* **high praise** = 高度讚賞

* **praise — religious** = 頌讚 / 讚美

* **praiseworthy** = 值得讚揚的

* **sing someone's praises** = 對某人讚不絕口

* **damn with faint praise** = 明褒暗貶

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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praise — verb	明確表達對某人 / 某事高度肯定、欣賞或認可
praise someone for X	因某項行為、品質或成就而稱讚某人
praise X as Y	公開肯定某人 / 某物具有某種優點或地位
praise — noun	對某人 / 某事表達的正面評價與欣賞
high praise	非常強烈、高度的正面評價
praise — religious	以崇敬、感恩或敬拜方式讚美神
praiseworthy	因表現、品格或行為良好而值得稱讚的
sing someone's praises	非常熱情、不斷地稱讚某人
damn with faint praise	用表面上的弱稱讚暗示實際評價不高

For your original sentence

> “I have heard colleagues, neighbours, and even people online **praising** it...”

The exact meaning is:

praising = 同事、鄰居和網民都在說 Golden Crust 的好話，對它的食物、品質或整體表現給予正面評價。

Natural translation:

> **「我聽過同事、鄰居，甚至網民都在稱讚它。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **praise a bakery** → 稱讚一間麵包店
- > **praise someone for X** → 因某事而表揚某人
- > **receive praise** → 獲得讚賞
- > **high praise** → 高度評價
- > **praise God** → 頌讚上帝
- > **praiseworthy** → 值得讚揚的
- > **praise vs admire** → 表達讚賞 vs 心中欣賞
- > **praise vs flatter** → 真誠 / 正常讚揚 vs 奉承